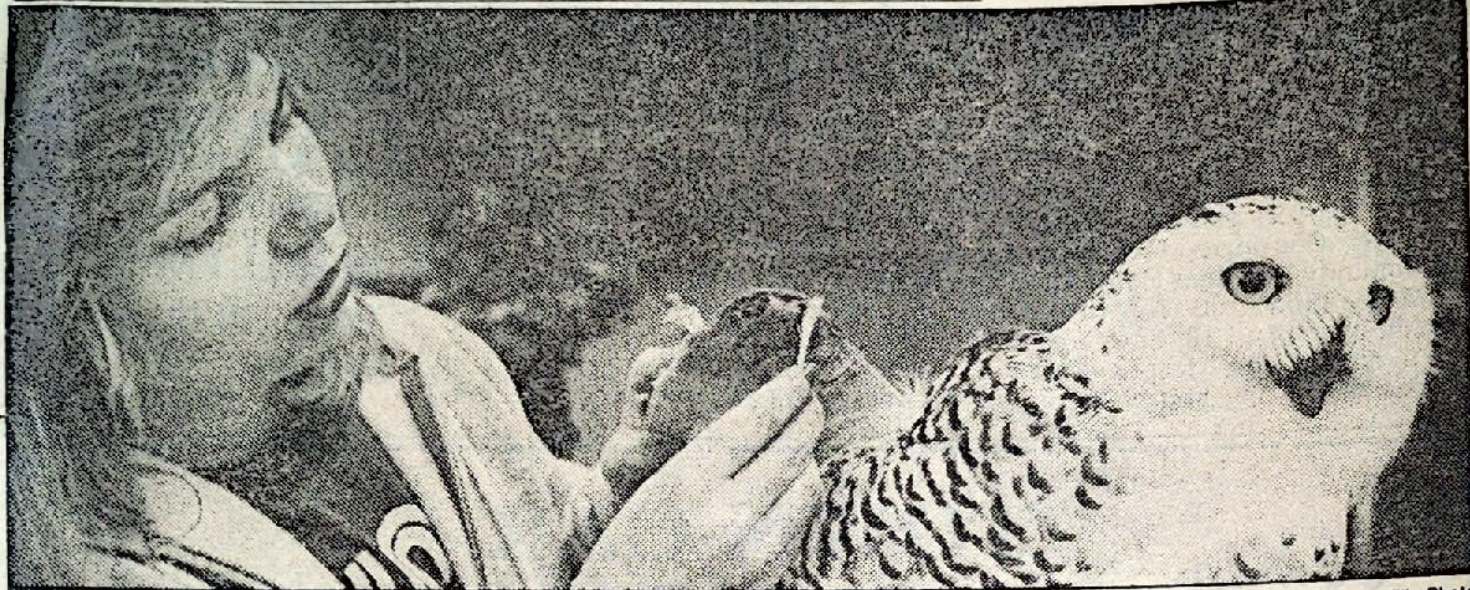




File Photo

Faye Dunn of the Carolina Raptor Center puts an antibiotic ointment on a snowy owl's injured wing.

Raptor Center Taking To Telephones In Hunt For New Prey: \$17,000

By GAIL SMITH
Staff Writer

The Carolina Raptor Center needs about \$17,000.

That's the amount cut from its requested Mecklenburg County funding.

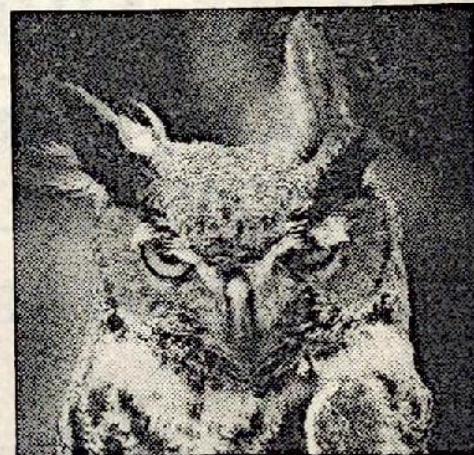
And so, this week, about 60 volunteers are calling center supporters to solicit financial help.

"We're hoping we can get most of that back from members and supporters," said Cindy Man-shack, the center's administrative

people asking what we are and when we're open. People are still finding out where we are," Man-shack said.

Want To Help?

If you want to help, call the Raptor Center office at 875-6521 from 9 a.m. to 5 p.m. weekdays.



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And so, this week, about 60 volunteers are calling center supporters to solicit financial help.

"We're hoping we can get most of that back from members and supporters," said Cindy Manshack, the center's administrative assistant. "I'm sure we'll make enough to take us through the next six months or so, then we'll be focusing on other fundraising efforts."

The nonprofit Raptor Center, which cares for injured birds of prey, requested \$50,000 from the county for 1988-89, a major portion of the center's total \$150,000 budget.

The center got \$33,000 — about a one-third cut from its request.

For the fundraising effort this week, First Union Corp. has donated the use of 30 telephone lines, office space and parking. Additional assistance has been provided by N.C. Chapter No. 35, Telephone Pioneers of America.

The Raptor Center depends primarily on memberships and donations to care for about 400 injured raptors each year and to conduct education, research and reproduction programs.

At the center, near Latta Plantation Park off Sample Road, volunteers and staff members care for eagles, owls, hawks and falcons and return them to the wild. Visitors can walk a nature trail to see birds that cannot be released because of health problems or other reasons. Admission is free.

After this summer's telephone drive, Manshack said supporters may find money through mailings and by stirring interest in the adopt-a-bird program.

Two years ago, the center was strictly a volunteer organization. Now, it has four full-time paid staffers. About 40 active volunteers also help on a regular basis.

Manshack also said the center could raise its profile in the community, with more displays at shopping malls and elsewhere.

"We frequently get calls from



File Photo

A red-tailed hawk's broken leg mended at the Carolina Raptor Center, where it was taken after being found injured in Union County. Holding the hawk is Deborah Griffin. Injured birds are released, if possible, after their injuries heal. Some, like the great horned owl (below left), make the center their home.